

Use-Case Flow Specification

Virtual Technical Conference Platform — Problem Statement #51

Nehaa Joshi | 5E | PES1UG24CS297

Use Case ID: UC-01

Use Case Name: Submit Manuscript

Primary Actor: Conference Author

Secondary Actors: Track Chair (receives the queued manuscript for reviewer assignment once anonymization completes); Notification Service (delivers the submission confirmation email)

Trigger: The Conference Author selects "Submit Manuscript" from the portal during an open submission window.

Stakeholders and Interests

- Conference Author — wants confirmation that the manuscript was received intact and correctly anonymized.
- Track Chair — wants a complete, correctly tagged manuscript queued promptly so reviewer assignment isn't delayed.
- Reviewer — relies on the manuscript being fully anonymized before it ever reaches them, to preserve double-blind review.
- Conference Organizers — need an accurate, timestamped submission record for the event's audit trail.

Preconditions

- The Conference Author has a registered account and is logged into the platform.
- The conference's submission window is currently open.
- The track list for the conference has been published by the organizers.

Postconditions

- Success: The manuscript is stored with a unique manuscript ID, an anonymized copy has been generated, the submission status is set to "Under Review," and the Author has received a confirmation.
- Failure: No manuscript record is created, and the Author is informed of the reason submission did not complete.

Main Success Scenario

1. Author logs into the portal and selects "Submit Manuscript."
2. System displays the submission form requesting title, abstract, track, keywords, and a file upload field.
3. Author selects a track and uploads the manuscript file (PDF).

4. System validates the file format (PDF) and size (≤ 20 MB).
5. System invokes the included use case «Anonymize Manuscript»: it strips author name, affiliation, and identifying metadata from the PDF to produce a review-ready copy.
6. System stores both the original and anonymized versions and assigns a unique manuscript ID.
7. System sets the submission status to "Under Review" and queues the manuscript for the Track Chair, who is notified that a new manuscript is ready for reviewer assignment.
8. System displays an on-screen confirmation with the manuscript ID, and the Notification Service emails a receipt to the Author.
9. Use case ends successfully.

Alternate Flow - 4a. Invalid or Oversized File

- **4a1.** At Step 4, the system detects an unsupported file type or a file exceeding 20 MB.
- **4a2.** System displays an error message identifying the problem and prompts the Author to re-upload.
- **4a3.** Author uploads a corrected file; the flow resumes at Step 4.
- **4a4.** If validation fails again after 2 attempts, the submission is cancelled, the Author is notified, and no manuscript record is created.

Exception Flow - E1. System Failure During Anonymization

- E1. At Step 5, the System encounters an unexpected error while anonymizing the manuscript.
- E2. The System stops the submission process and does not queue the manuscript for reviewer assignment.
- E3. The System preserves the original uploaded manuscript securely and records the processing error for the Conference Organizers to investigate.
- E4. The System displays an error message informing the Author that the manuscript could not be processed and that the submission was not completed.
- E5. The Notification Service sends the Author a failure notification if the email service is available.
- E6. The Author may retry the submission after the issue has been resolved.